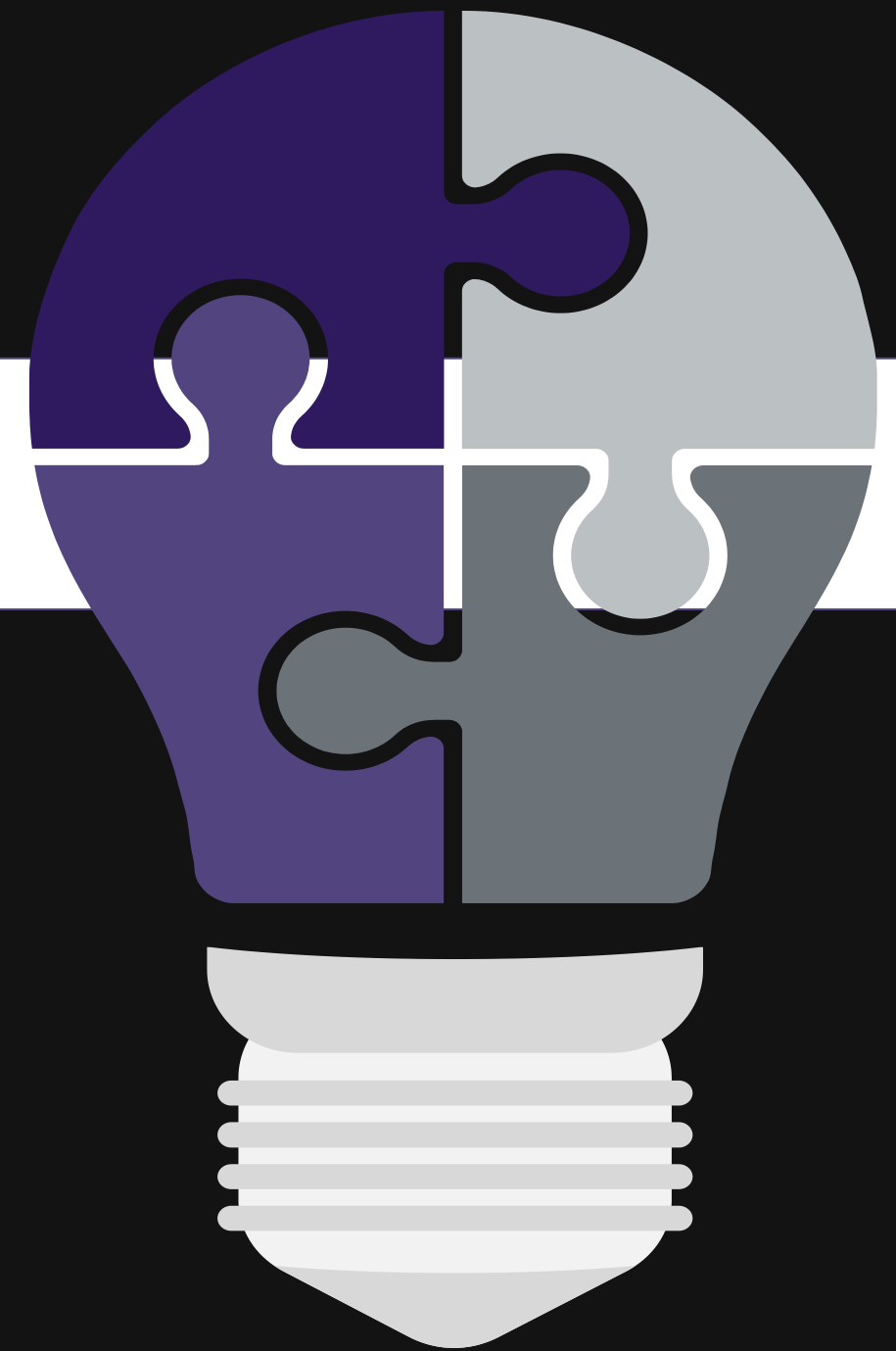


PROJECT MANAGEMENT PLAYBOOK

EVALUATE PROJECT SUCCESS

Develop a Project Closure Report



COMPLETE: Project summary

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
Which areas would you include in your Moodies project summary section of your closure report? Consider the project summary areas: <i>objectives, deliverables, budget, risks, schedule, communication plan, and project team.</i>	<i>Not all of these areas need to be included. Highlight those that had the biggest impact on the “story” of your project. Remember to be objective and data driven in your analysis.</i> I would include Objectives, Deliverables, Budget, Risks, Schedule and Project team. because these areas best capture the project's outcomes, challenges, and overall performance. ● Objectives: Show which goals were met or missed. ● Deliverables: Summarize the key project outputs. ● Budget: Highlight the \$3,400 over budget and its causes. ● Risks: Explain the major risks that affected the project. ● Schedule: Show the impact of delays on the project timeline. ● Project Team: Explain how team member changes, including the QA tester leaving and the content author’s leave, affected resources, costs and timelines. I would not prioritize Communication Plan as they had less impact on the overall project story.

COMPLETE: Project summary – Objectives

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
Were the project objectives met?	Partially. The project exceeded the customer satisfaction target but did not fully achieve the response time and social media objectives.
Explain your reasoning; support your answer with data.	Customer satisfaction: Target was 20% increase; actual result was 25% increase. Exceeded. Response time: Target was 40% reduction; actual result was 10% reduction. Not met. Social media questions: Target was 80% reduction; actual result was 50% reduction. Partially met

COMPLETE: Project summary – Objectives

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
For each objective, what factors contributed to the success or failure?	1. Customer satisfaction: Clearer content and easier to find FAQs contributed to exceeding the target. 2. Response time: The launch of new products increased the overall volume of inquiries, limiting the reduction in response time. 3. Social media questions: The delayed website launch reduced customer awareness of the redesigned FAQs, contributing to the target not being fully achieved.

COMPLETE: Project summary – Risks

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
What risks were identified over the course of the project?	1. Insufficient QA resources: The QA tester left the company, requiring a replacement and causing delays and additional costs. 2. Resource constraints: The content author went on maternity leave earlier than expected, requiring work to be reassigned. 3. Translation requirement: A new English/Spanish policy requirement was identified after the project had started, adding unplanned work, cost, and schedule impact.
Is there anything that could have been proactively planned for to predict and mitigate these risks earlier on?	Yes. The team could have: 1. QA resource: Identify backup resources for critical roles and maintain contingency capacity for unexpected turnover. 2. Content resource: Create a backup plan for key resources who may become unavailable during the project. 3. Compliance requirements: Add a compliance and policy review during project initiation to identify applicable requirements before finalizing scope, budget, and schedule. Use this project's translation requirement as a lesson learned for future projects. 4. The maternity leave risk was identified and tracked from the beginning, but the team could have strengthened the backup plan.

COMPLETE: Project summary – Budget

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
What was the total budget established at the start of the project?	\$125,000
What was the actual budget spent on the project?	\$128,400
What categories were over budget? Why did they go over?	1. Contractors: \$25,000 vs. \$13,000 — additional QA resources were needed. 2. Personnel/Labor: \$75,300 vs. \$66,300 — additional hours were required. 3. Software: \$3,100 vs. \$1,100 — unexpected licensing fees. 4. Translation: Unexpected translation costs due to the English/Spanish requirement.

COMPLETE: Project summary – Budget

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
What could you do differently next time to estimate your project budget more accurately?	1. Build backup resources and contingency for critical roles. 2. Include potential translation and licensing costs during budget planning. 3. Conduct a compliance review during project initiation. 4. Maintain a larger contingency reserve for unexpected resource and compliance related costs.

COMPLETE: Project summary – Schedule

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
Was the project schedule adhered to?	No. The project was planned to finish on May 30 but was completed on June 17, resulting in an 18 day delay.
If not, why not? What factors caused delays and what activities took less time than expected?	1. Content Writing & Review: 20 days planned → 30 days actual. 2. Translation: An additional 11 day activity was added. 3. QA Test Planning: 10 days planned → 20 days actual. 4. QA Testing: 5 days planned → 20 days actual. 5. Resource changes: The QA tester left, and the content author went on leave earlier than expected.
Were there unknown dependencies?	Yes. The English/Spanish translation requirement was identified after the project had started, adding an unplanned activity and affecting the schedule. The QA resource change also created additional dependency and affected downstream activities.

COMPLETE: What went well

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
Identify three major positive themes or highlights. Use the project retrospective and the information from the project summary as a guide.	1. Customer satisfaction exceeded expectations — increased by 25%, exceeding the 20% target. 2. Strong team collaboration and communication — the retrospective highlighted effective collaboration, communication, and adherence to project processes. 3. Successful reduction in customer questions — social media questions decreased by 50%, showing that the redesigned FAQs helped customers find answers.
Choose one of the three highlights you listed above and expand upon why you think it was a highlight. What factors contributed to success?	Customer satisfaction increased by 25%, exceeding the 20% target. This was a major highlight because customers specifically appreciated the clearer content and ease of finding FAQs. The team collaboration and focus on improving the customer experience contributed to this success.



Hint: Use AI to spotlight the wins from your project. Upload your retrospective notes and prompt the AI to identify a few positive themes. Need ideas on how to frame your prompt? Check back to the AI-powered closure report activity for guidance. (Optional)

COMPLETE: Opportunities and lessons learned

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
Identify three opportunities for improvement. Use the project retrospective and the information from the project summary as a guide.	1. Resource planning: Have backup resources for critical roles to reduce the impact of unexpected team changes. 2. Compliance planning: Add a compliance/policy review during project initiation to identify requirements early. 3. QA and schedule planning: Allocate sufficient QA resources and contingency time for testing and issue resolution.
Choose one of the three opportunities you listed above and elaborate on the corresponding lesson learned. What could you do differently next time?	Compliance planning: Opportunity: Compliance requirements were identified after the project was underway, resulting in unexpected translation work, cost, and schedule impact. Lesson Learned: Add a compliance and policy review as a standard step during project initiation. This can help identify applicable requirements before finalizing the project scope, budget, and schedule.



Hint: AI can also help you spot growth opportunities. Upload the retro notes and ask the AI to suggest three areas for improvement. Then compare its suggestions with your own observations and combine both to create your top three opportunities for improvement.

COMPLETE: Communication

PROMPT/QUESTION	RESPONSE
Name three potential audiences you would share the project closure report with.	1. Project Sponsor / Leadership – to review project outcomes, budget, and overall performance. 2. Project Team – to share results and lessons learned. 3. Customer Service Department – to understand the improvements and support the transition to the redesigned process.
Write a brief email sharing the project closure report (assume the report is attached or linked to from the email).	Subject: Moodies Customer Support Redesign – Project Closure Hi Moodies Team, The Customer Support Experience Redesign project is now complete. Please find the Project Closure Report attached for a summary of the project outcomes, budget, schedule, key successes, and lessons learned. Thank you to everyone who contributed to the project and supported the team through the challenges and changes along the way. Best, Radha Manjunath Project Manager